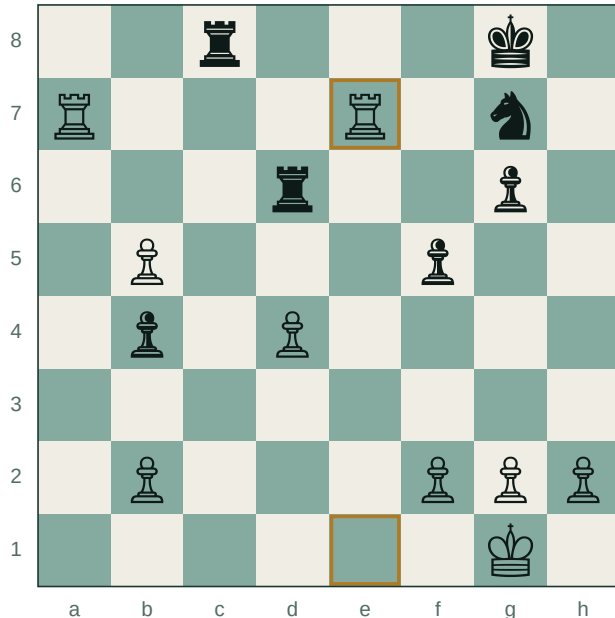


# Back-rank mates: Black, move 31

Back-rank mates

## Black to move



Previous move: 31.Ree7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

### 31...Rc1+ 32. Re1 Rxe1#

**31...Rc1+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **32.Re1**.

**32...Rxe1#** Mate: rook on e1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

## CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A flight square, an interposition, or a countercheck may refute an apparent mate. Check all three before sacrificing material.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A king trapped behind its own pawns may have no flight square when a rook or queen reaches its back rank. The entry square and its defenders are critical.

## HOW TO LOOK

Inspect the king's pawn shelter, then find how a heavy piece can enter the last rank or remove its defender.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.